



STATION AURORA

HAROLD / EMERGENCY COMMUNICATIONS

LOCAL HARDCOPY / 12 MARCH 2032

URGENT

MICROMETEORITE STRIKE

FROM HAROLD

TO DR. SARAH LANCASTER

Dr. Lancaster, a micrometeorite strike has damaged Aurora. You appear to have struck your head during the impact. Preliminary scans suggest you may be experiencing memory loss.

Commander Helena Chen and Engineer Alistair Johnson are sealed inside the crew quarters. You are the only crew member currently able to reach the damaged sections.

You have located Engineer Johnson's emergency backpack. Some repair tools are locked inside its compartments. I have begun compiling the information you will need to open them.

My communications system is failing. Before we can proceed, you must restore the optical interface in the open pocket of the backpack.

FIRST ACTION / RESTORE THE INTERFACE

Find the six repair patches and the optical maintenance diagram. Match every patch to its outline, keep the same orientation, and transfer it to the corresponding position on the interface. Install all six patches, then scan.

I will guide you through the remaining repairs once the connection is res...

[LINK LOST] [PRINT BUFFER INCOMPLETE]

Optical interface

PLAYER PANEL - KEEP FLAT AND UPRIGHT

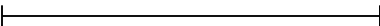
Communications link damaged.
Install all six repair patches before scanning.

TOP / ALIGN THIS EDGE

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25



Use the maintenance diagram to locate the repairs. Row and column numbers refer to the small squares inside the code.

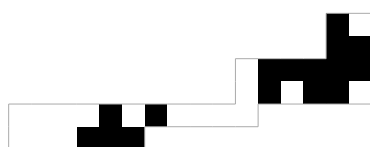
 This line must measure exactly 50 mm.

Repair patches / cut sheet

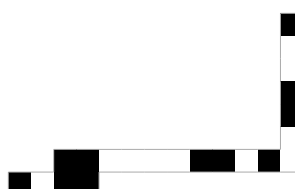
PREPARATION SHEET - CUT BEFORE GIVING TO PLAYERS

Print single-sided at **100% / Actual size**. Use opaque white paper. Cut around each irregular outer outline, retaining every white square. The letters identify loose pieces during preparation; they are not part of the patches.

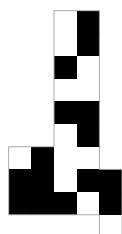
PATCH A



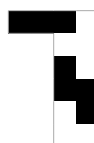
PATCH B



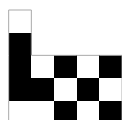
PATCH C



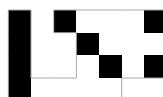
PATCH D



PATCH E



PATCH F



This line must measure exactly 50 mm.

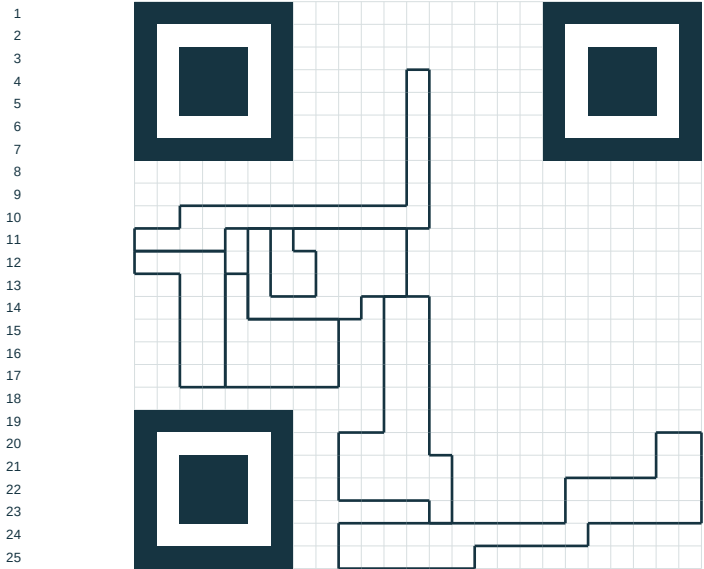
Optical maintenance diagram

AURORA ENGINEERING / EMERGENCY REPAIR PROCEDURE

- 1. **Match** each repair patch to its shape below, printed face up.
- 2. **Transfer** it to the same rows and columns on the optical interface.
- 3. **Reconnect** after installing all six. Keep TOP pointing up.

TOP / ALIGN THIS EDGE

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25



The three large corner markers establish orientation.
The small grid squares on this diagram and the interface are the same size. Do not rotate or turn over a patch during transfer.

Test setup / facilitator only

KEEP THIS PAGE AND THE CUT-SHEET OFFCUTS AWAY FROM PLAYERS

Print: US Letter, single-sided, Actual size / 100%. Do not use Fit or Shrink. The 50 mm rulers on pages 2 and 3 must match. Each QR square is 3 mm; the code is 75 mm wide, or 99 mm including its white quiet zone.

Prepare: give players page 1 (briefing), page 2 (base panel), page 4 (maintenance diagram) and the six cut patches from page 3. Secure patches flat with small amounts of removable adhesive underneath. Leave the white border clear.

Check first: the bare panel should decode to <https://escapepack.ca/coms>. All six patches should decode to <https://escapepack.ca/Harold> (capital H). These pages have not been verified as deployed; reading the URL is enough for a paper test.

Accepted behavior: earlier ideal-image tests found four five-patch subsets also decode to HAROLD. This prototype asks for all six, but does not enforce that physically. Test with actual phones, lighting and paper before production.

PLACEMENT REFERENCE / 1-BASED ROWS AND COLUMNS

- A Rows 20-25 Columns 10-25 (33 squares)
- B Rows 4-11 Columns 1-13 (21 squares)
- C Rows 14-23 Columns 10-14 (27 squares)
- D Rows 12-17 Columns 1-4 (14 squares)
- E Rows 13-17 Columns 5-9 (17 squares)
- F Rows 11-14 Columns 6-12 (21 squares)

Observe: can players identify all six outlines, preserve orientation, align the 3 mm cells and scan the result? A few strips are only one square wide. If cutting or alignment dominates the experience, enlarge the entire pack together for another test.